were the transfer of the Persian Gulf to the foreign office, the separation of Burma in 1935, the weakening of Indian policy towards Tibet and British Indian influence in Kashgar. 'What seems to be required in the light of the experience of the present [Second World] war is the reconstitution of the old Indian empire on a different basis.'[53]

Panikkar spoke of a 'fourth British empire' which would be 'a world commonwealth in a true sense and one which will be justly entitled to claim the moral leadership of the world'. [54] Panikkar believed that since, in 1947, a newly independent India was too weak to defend herself and needed to build her military and economic strength and obtain modern technology, and the best way to do so was through cooperation with Britain.[55]

In his 1943 book *The Future of South-East Asia*, Panikkar had already argued that in history India had been the 'only' power able to control South-East Asia or what he called 'Further India'.[56] Panikkar saw India as the security provider as well as the key economic power for the region because of its 'geographical position, size, resources, manpower and industrial potential'.[57] He even cited President Quezon of the Philippines who declared: 'Without a free India, no nation in South East Asia can be free.'[58] That Panikkar was not alone in this view is seen in the 1946 book titled *India's Foreign Policy* written by Iqbal Singh, which argued for defence-based regional groupings both for the Middle-East and South-East Asia, with India at the core of both.[59]

In a 1948 pamphlet titled *Regionalism and Security*, published by the Indian Council of World Affairs, Panikkar argued for the creation of a regional organization comprising several countries: India, Pakistan, Ceylon, Burma, Malaya, Iran, Iraq, Afghanistan, Thailand, French Indo-China, Indonesia, Australia and Britain. VT Krishnamachari, in his chapter for Panikkar's book, argued for the creation of a defence council of all these countries and even spoke of military and naval bases in Socotra, Mauritius,